

## Multi-loadcell simulators

Calibration, testing and troubleshooting of instrumentation for strain-gauge-based sensors is a laborious task. Precision portable calibrators simplify this complex process. The ME 1310 series multi-loadcell simulators from Microedge Electronics bridge this vital need. These are useful for production testing, repair and service personnel dealing with strain-gauge instrumentation.

Consisting of precision wire-wound/MFR star bridge networks to simulate single or multiple sensors in parallel, the ME 1310 generates precise differential mV signals in accordance with the system excitation voltage and mV/V rating of sensors. System zero point (offset) is simulated independently by means of a multiturn potentiometer. The SPAN potentiometer is useful for calibration, set-point simulation and performance monitoring of instrumentation.

Microedge Electronics, Chennai

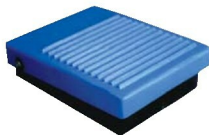
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## TOOLS & EQUIPMENT

### Foot switch

Precision Engineering has developed a foot switch called 'Gemstar.' With its body manufactured from aluminium casting, the switch is strong enough to withstand wear and tear. It has a



capacity of 15A/250V AC and encapsulates three-terminal switching elements and single-changeover NO/NC contact. Four rubber buttons are

provided at the base to avoid skidding while operating.

Precision Engineering Corporation, Mumbai

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### SLA battery charging module

There are various kinds of sealed lead-acid (SLA) battery-charging controller ICs available in the market but these generally require a large number of extra components and programming to achieve the recommended charg-



ing process. Silver Telecom, based in South Wales in the UK, has released a complete charging solution that offers extra benefits.

The Silvertel Ag102 module requires only two-three additional components and is simple to use. The PCB area taken up is small. In addition to providing the recommended three-state charging and temperature compensation, there is no need for an extra supply rail to supply the battery charger as it has a wide input range of 9-36V. It uses an intermittent float charge to top up the battery, which prevents over charging and saves energy. The unit has a high efficiency of 86 per cent.

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### KVM switch with touch-screen LCD

ATEN International has launched an all-in-one KVM switch with a touch-screen LCD monitor. The KL3116T offers secure access to 16 servers with dual USB or PS/2 interface, and can be mounted in only 1U of rack space. The

touch-screen LCD requires no additional driver installation and no serial-port switch to operate—simply connect the IT devices for operation. The touch screen enables server operations to



be managed in a quick and comfortable way, in particular where quick configuration changes are required.

Cubix Micro Systems (I) Pvt Ltd, Pune

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### Sliding light-guide interconnect unit

DIGILINK has launched a sliding light-guide interconnect unit (LIU) under its OptiPlus fibre range. An LIU is essentially a fibre distribution box wherein the fibre backbone cables and the equipment cables are terminated. The fibre spools provide minimum bending radius and the splice trays function as a splice cover for pigtail splicing. Together they function as an excellent interfacing unit for fibre cables coming in from the field and those originating from the equipment.

The unique sliding rack-mount panel is good for applications requiring an extremely compact and easy-to-use design. It can be used to patch and splice fibres and to provide cross-connection capability. It accommodates up to 24 connections and can use a wide variety of connector types.

DIGILINK, Mumbai

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### ARM 926 development kit

Innovate Software Solutions has launched the ARM 926 development kit—a low-cost, multi-peripheral rapid-prototyping board for applications based on Atmel AT91SAM9263 (ARM 926 EJ5 core). The board is RoHS-com-